



Android Wear 2.0

After much delay, Android Wear 2.0 finally set to launch this month according to an email from Google <http://dgit.in/AWear2feb>



Stop global warming!

And while you're at it, could you take this 5 minute survey as well please? <http://dgit.in/dsurvey17>

Bazaar

Xiaomi Redmi Note 4

Jack of all trades

The Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 is the company's first smartphone of 2017 and it has a lot to live up to. The Redmi Note 3 set quite the example last year, becoming the phone to beat. Moreover, the market has indeed changed since then, with better devices available for around the same price. Needless to say, the Redmi Note 4 is fighting a tough battle this time.

On performance benchmarks, the phone is noticeably slower, while the same is exhibited in real world usage sometimes. For example, the Redmi Note 4 shows slight stutters on Asphalt 8 menus and transitions. Similarly, Amazing Spiderman 2 also stutters a few times.

To be clear, lag or stutters aren't enough to really hamper performance. In fact, the Redmi Note 4 manages regular tasks well, keeping app load times reasonably low as well. We've seen many Snapdragon 625-powered smartphones that are slower than this. Moreover, the Note 4 keeps temperatures within permissible limits, never rising beyond 37 degrees over 30 minutes of gaming.

Further, Xiaomi has also improved on the camera. The Redmi Note 4 still has a 13MP sensor, but it shoots brighter and warmer photos, even pleasantly oversaturated at times. Further, the low light performance is better and images in general have greater details and sharpness. However, this doesn't hold a candle to the Coolpad Cool 1 or Honor 6X.

In comparison, the Note 4 remains distinctly weak in lower light, including indoor conditions. Photos can be darker than they need to be and while details are better than the Note 3, that's not saying much. Low Light photos still have above average noise.

The battery, on the other hand, is a definite improvement. The Note 4 has the same display as its predecessor, while the Snapdragon 625 is much more power efficient than the 650. Xiaomi has compromised performance to



Price
₹10,999

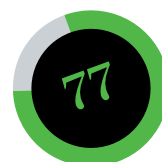
extend battery life. In practical terms, this amounts to about 5 hours more battery life than the Redmi Note 3. It can differ, based on usage, but even the heaviest users should be able to get this phone to last a full day.

On the PC Mark Work 2.0 battery test, the Redmi Note 4 runs for 8 hours 55 minutes. This is an accurate representation of the amount of Screen On Time you can expect on heavy usage. Depending on your usage, 8-10 hours is what you should expect, and that is on the upper end of the spectrum today. The Lenovo P2 offers about double the battery life, but it is expensive and in a league of its own.

Of course, battery life is aided by the FHD display as well. The maximum brightness is low, with luminance ratings of 474 Lux, which is less than ideal. However, the display is colourful and vibrant, with a reasonably wide colour gamut. Sunlight visibility isn't ideal, but functional.

Altogether, the Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 is a decent and dependable smartphone. However, it is not a big upgrade from the Redmi Note 3. Xiaomi has improved aspects of the phone, but we wouldn't recommend putting down your Note 3 just yet. If you're buying a new device, the Coolpad Cool 1 has a better camera and comparable battery life, while it performs a lot better than the Note 4. If you can spend the extra Rs. 1000, we would recommend the Cool 1 to you. In essence, the Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 is a jack of all trades, but master of none.

Xiaomi has priced it well, though. The phone comes in three variants, including two 32GB versions, with 2 and 3GB of RAM, priced at Rs. 9,999 and 10,999 respectively. These are indeed pretty good options for anyone who doesn't want to spend a lot of money. It's the top-end version of the Note 4, the one with 4GB RAM and 64GB ROM, that goes up against the toughest of competition.



Features 84
Design 78
Performance 70
Value 75

Specifications

Display: 5.5 inch FHD IPS LCD; **RAM:** 2/3/4GB; **ROM:** 32/64GB; **Battery:** 4100 mAh; **SoC:** Qualcomm Snapdragon 625; **Operating System:** Android Nougat Preview, with MIUI 8

Contact

Phone: 18001036286
Website: <http://www.mi.com/in/service/online/>

Prasid Banerjee